

A L^AT_EX Template for Transportation Research Board Annual Meeting Papers

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1 ABSTRACT

2 For the 2027 Transportation Research Board (TRB) Annual Meeting, TRB has updated their re-
3 quirements for the submission process. This template offers a pragmatic starting point for authors
4 using LaTeX (and related literate programming tools) while matching TRB conventions. Note that
5 the Abstract now must be formatted as a structured abstract per TRB guidance and it must be less
6 than 300 words. The content below summarizes what each section of the structured abstract should
7 include based on TRB's Instructions For Authors.

8
9 **Objectives:** In 2–3 sentences, define the specific transportation problem and context. State the
10 objective of this paper and the specific need being addressed. Do not include broad background or
11 literature review content.

12
13 **Methods:** In 3–4 sentences, describe the study design and technical rigor. Identify data type(s),
14 source(s), and scope (e.g., sample size, time frame, and geography). Summarize the analytical
15 approach used to evaluate the objective.

16
17 **Findings:** In 2–3 sentences, report the most important results. Indicate whether results are sig-
18 nificant based on statistical testing, sensitivity analysis, validation, and/or rigorous qualitative
19 assessment.

20
21 **Novelty:** In 1–2 sentences, clearly state the novel transportation contribution of this work.

22
23 **Practical Applications:** In 1–2 sentences, explain how findings inform transportation practice
24 and/or policy, including specific implementation considerations or operational contexts.

1 INTRODUCTION

2 The Transportation Research Board (TRB) currently requires submissions of full papers to be
3 considered for presentation at the TRB Annual Meeting (Transportation Research Board 2025).
4 The Instructions For Authors website (<https://trb.secure-platform.com/a/page/TRBPaperReview>)
5 outlines specific requirements for submissions. Initial submissions are PDFs, while accepted papers
6 for the *Transportation Research Record* may require Microsoft Office formats. Manuscripts must
7 be line-numbered; captions are bold with TRB-specific punctuation; in-text citations now use
8 author–date format, and the reference list is alphabetical rather than numbered. See the author
9 information online at <https://trb.secure-platform.com/a/page/TRBPaperReview>.

10 We assume basic familiarity with $\text{\LaTeX}$ and `bibtex`. As literate programming becomes
11 more common, the template may evolve to support additional workflows.

12 History

13 David R. Pritchard Pritchard (2025) released the original template in 2009 and updated it in
14 2011. Gregory S. Macfarlane Macfarlane (2025) extended it in 2012 (Sweave integration and
15 auto counts). C. Ross Wang Wang (2025) automated total word count calculation and improved
16 formatting in 2015, added GitHub releases in 2016, and provided $\text{\TeX}$ -only variants in 2017
17 (https://github.com/chiehrosswang/TRB_LaTeX_tex) and an RNW version (<https://github.com/c>
18 [hiehrosswang/TRB_LaTeX_rnw](https://github.com/c)). The 2019 and 2025 updates focused on the $\text{\TeX}$ -only version:
19 the 2019 update improved Overleaf compatibility, while the 2025 update enhanced word-counting
20 and authorship blocks.

21 FEATURES

22 This template targets quick and TRB-compliant manuscript assembly (Transportation Research
23 Board 2025).

24 Title Page

25 The class provides a custom `\maketitle` that prints authors (via `\TRBauthor`), a word count
26 (with tables counted as 250 words each by default), and the submission date. Word counting uses
27 `texcount` via shell escape; compile with `--shell-escape` (see the BUILD section).

28 Page Layout

29 Margins are 1 in. The running header shows authors (set with `\AuthorHeaders`) at the left and
30 the page number at the right. Headings and spacing follow TRB conventions.

31 Line Numbers

32 Line numbering uses the `lineno` package and resets each page. Blank lines are not numbered. The
33 `numbered` class option enables line numbers.

34 MORE FEATURES

35 Captions

36 Figure 1 shows a Gumbel distribution as an example. Figure captions use sentence case. Table
37 captions use Title Case and function as a short title. Table 1 summarizes the template history. Both
38 Figure and Table captions are bold.

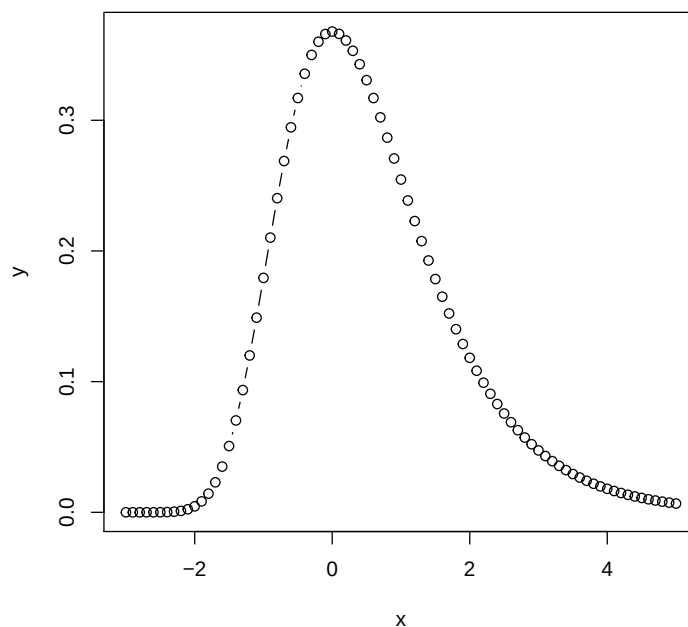


FIGURE 1 Example figure illustrating the caption style and counting on the title page.

TABLE 1 A History of this Template

Version	Date	Author	Contributions
1.0	Sep 2009	Pritchard	Initial work
1.1	Mar 2011	Pritchard	Caption fixes
2.0	Mar 2012	Macfarlane	Automation, documentation
2.1	Jul 2015	Wang	More automation and formatting
2.1.1	Jan 2016	Wang	Minor modifications; GitHub
2.1.1 Lite	Jun 2017	Wang	T _E X-only template
3.1	Jun 2017	Wang	Added <code>trbunofficial.cls</code>
3.1 Lite	Jun 2017	Wang	Added <code>trbunofficial.cls</code>
4.0 Lite	Jul 2019	Wang	Word-count updates for Overleaf
5.0 Lite	Aug 2025	Wang	Word-count improvements*

* Total counts include: Title, front matter, body texts, headers, captions, references. Total word counts do not include text in tables (each table is automatically counted as 250 words).

1 Bibliography

2 Use `trb.bst`. The commands `\cite{}` and `\citet{}` produce author–date citations. References
3 appear in alphabetical order by first author. Here is an example using `\cite[]{} (Meyer and
4 Miller 2001, 21-25)` and another example Garrow et al. (2009) using `\citet{}`.

5 Other examples include Bierlaire (2003, 2008); Garrow et al. (2009); Koppelman and

1 Garrow (2005) and grouped citations (Bierlaire 2003; Garrow et al. 2009; Koppelman and
2 Garrow 2005).

3 **Equations**

4 Equations are left aligned with no extra indentation. Below is the Intelligent Driver Model (from
5 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Intelligent_driver_model).

$$6 \quad \dot{x}_\alpha = \frac{dx_\alpha}{dt} = v_\alpha, \quad (1)$$

$$7 \quad \dot{v}_\alpha = \frac{dv_\alpha}{dt} = a \left(1 - \left(\frac{v_\alpha}{v_0} \right)^\delta - \left(\frac{s^*(v_\alpha, \Delta v_\alpha)}{s_\alpha} \right)^2 \right), \quad (2)$$

$$8 \quad s^*(v_\alpha, \Delta v_\alpha) = s_0 + v_\alpha T + \frac{v_\alpha \Delta v_\alpha}{2\sqrt{ab}}. \quad (3)$$

9 **Referencing Sections by Custom Names**

10 Because this template does not use section numbering, referencing sections directly can be difficult.
11 To address this, you can create hyperlinks to labeled sections with your own display text using the
12 `\customref` command: `\customref{Displayed Text}{label}`.

13 For example, if you have defined `\label{sec:intro}` for the Introduction section, you can
14 write `\customref{INTRODUCTION section}{sec:intro}` to produce a hyperlink that appears
15 as INTRODUCTION section.

16 **CONCLUSION AND BUILD**

17 To build with automatic word counting:

18 `latexmk trb_template.tex -pdf -pvc`

19 **ACKNOWLEDGMENTS**

20 We thank Aleksandar Trifunovic (<https://github.com/akstrfn>) for putting together the initial
21 `trbunofficial` class that advanced this work.

22 **AUTHOR CONTRIBUTIONS**

23 The authors confirm contribution to the paper as follows: study conception and design: X. Author,
24 Y. Author; data collection: Y. Author; analysis and interpretation of results: X. Author, Y. Author,
25 Z. Author; draft manuscript preparation: Y. Author, Z. Author. All authors reviewed the results
26 and approved the final version of the manuscript.

27 **DECLARATION OF CONFLICTING INTERESTS**

28 X. Author is a member of Transportation Research Record's Editorial Board. All other authors
29 declare no potential conflicts of interest with respect to the research, authorship, and publication of
30 this article.

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